LESSON 2

Au clair de la lune

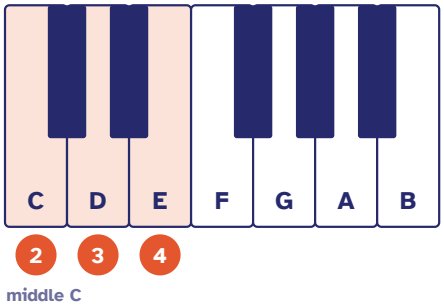
An old French folk song: Pierrot is asked, by moonlight, to lend his pen.

IN THIS SONG **steps up and down** **a skip** **the semibreve** **fingers 2 3 4**

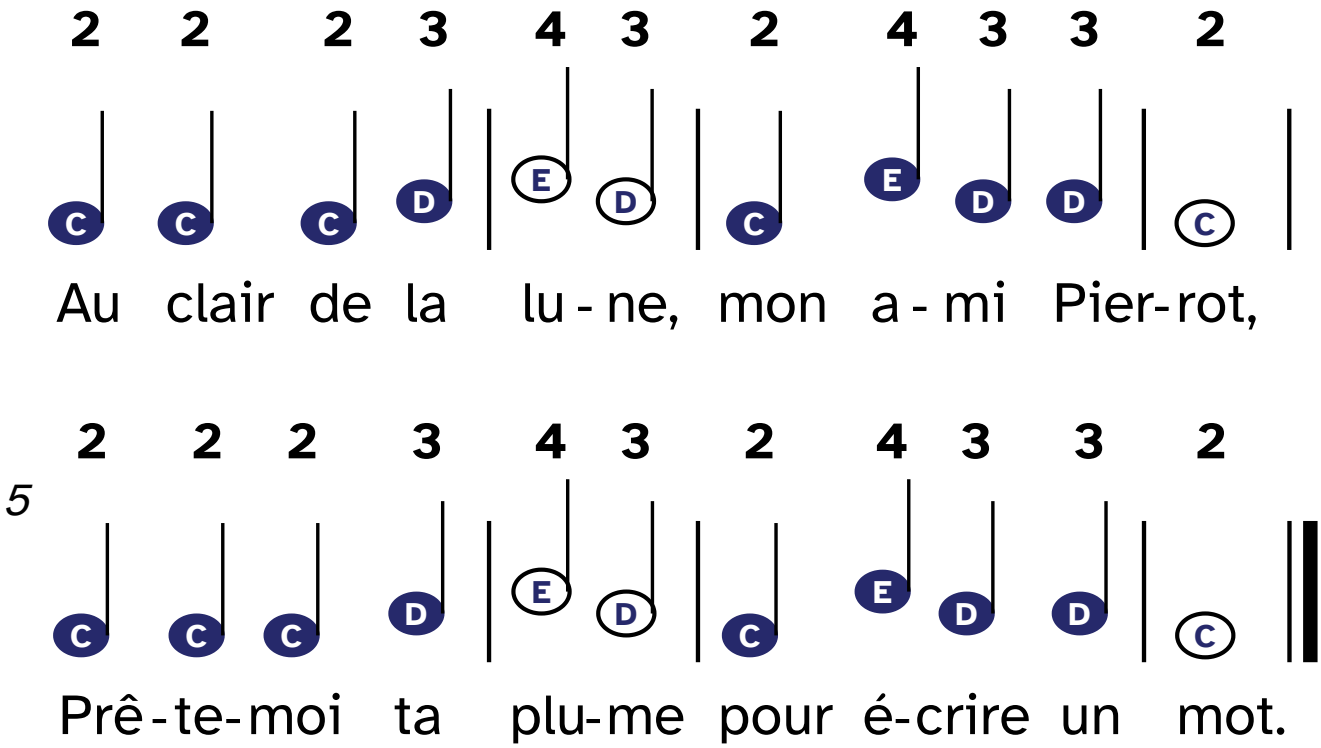
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand. Lesson 1's keys: 2 on C, 3 on D, 4 on E.
Steps and a skip. The tune steps up and down, and once it skips: C straight to E, missing D.



☐ Listened and pointed ☐ Sang it with the words ☐ Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 3 4 in every bar: four beats a bar now.
Walk on a beat; hold a minim for two; hold a semibreve for the whole bar.

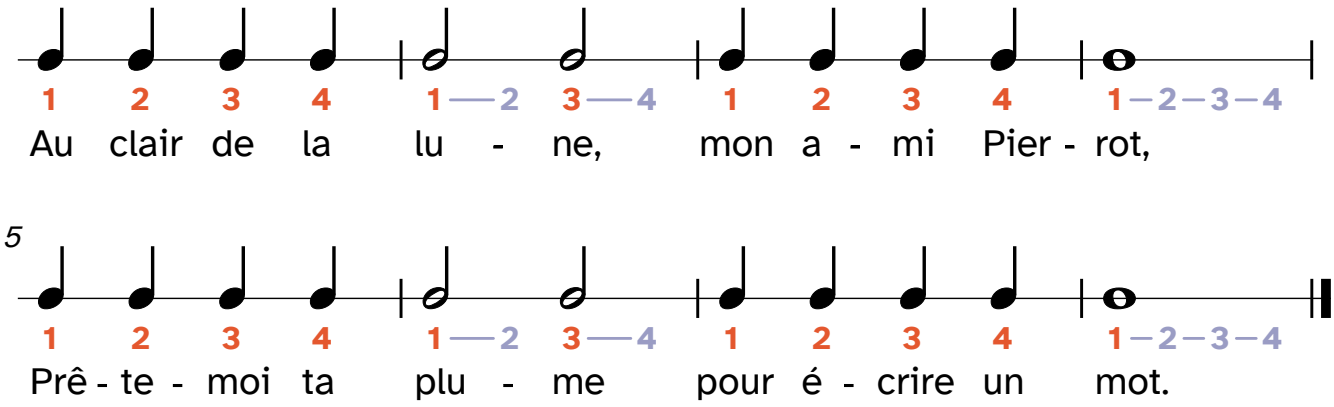
THE NOTES



crotchet: walk — 1 beat

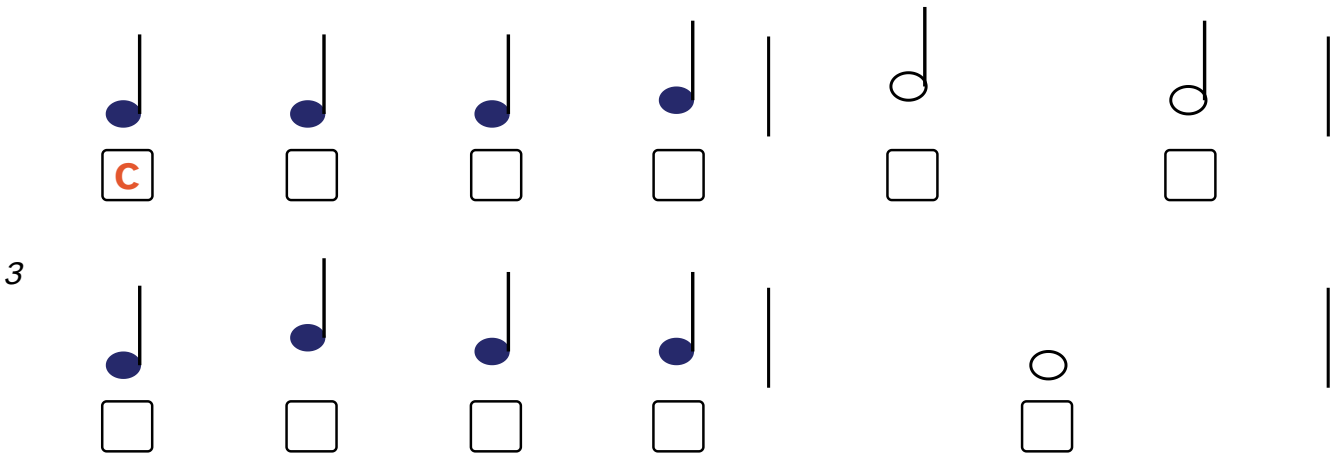
minim: hold — 2 beats

semibreve: hold-2-3-4 — 4 beats



THE NOTES

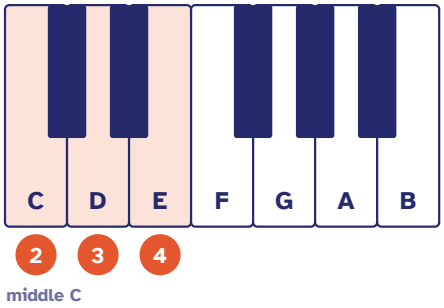
Write C, D or E in each box of the first four bars. Then circle the skip: C straight to E.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Found the skip**

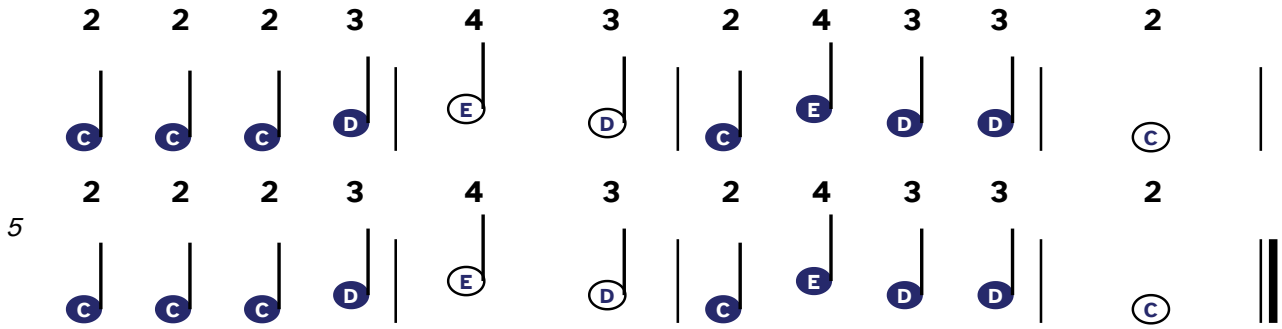
3 Play it

The white keys C D E again, with the right hand, then the left.

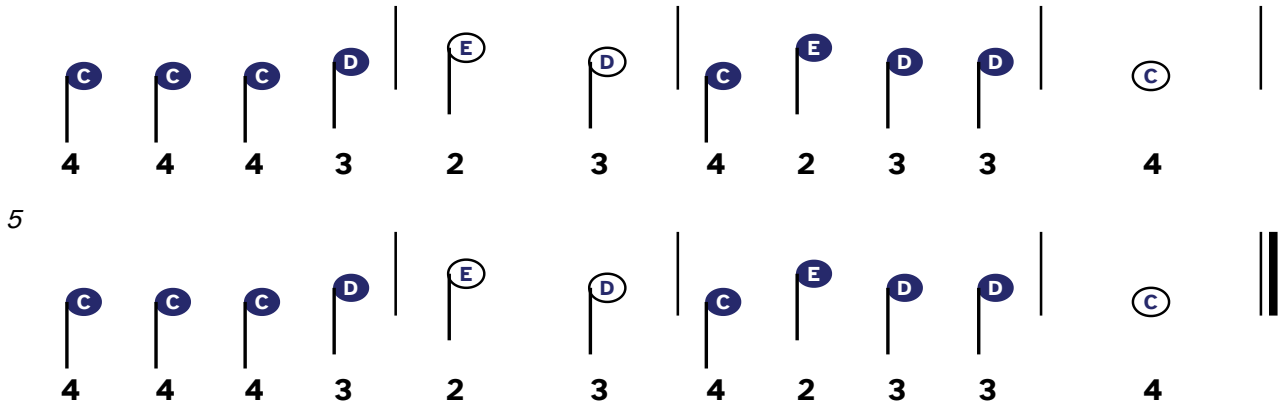


Right hand: 2 on middle C, 3 on D, 4 on E. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 4 on C, 3 on D, 2 on E.

R RIGHT HAND 2 3 4



L LEFT HAND 4 3 2, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can sing the letter names

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand
- ☐ Left hand

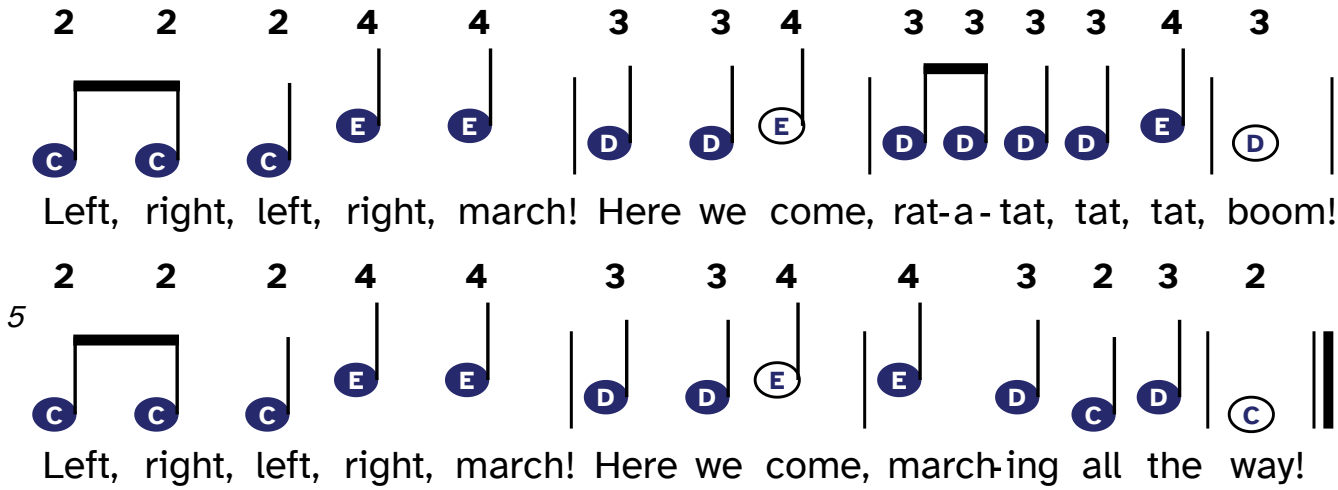
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

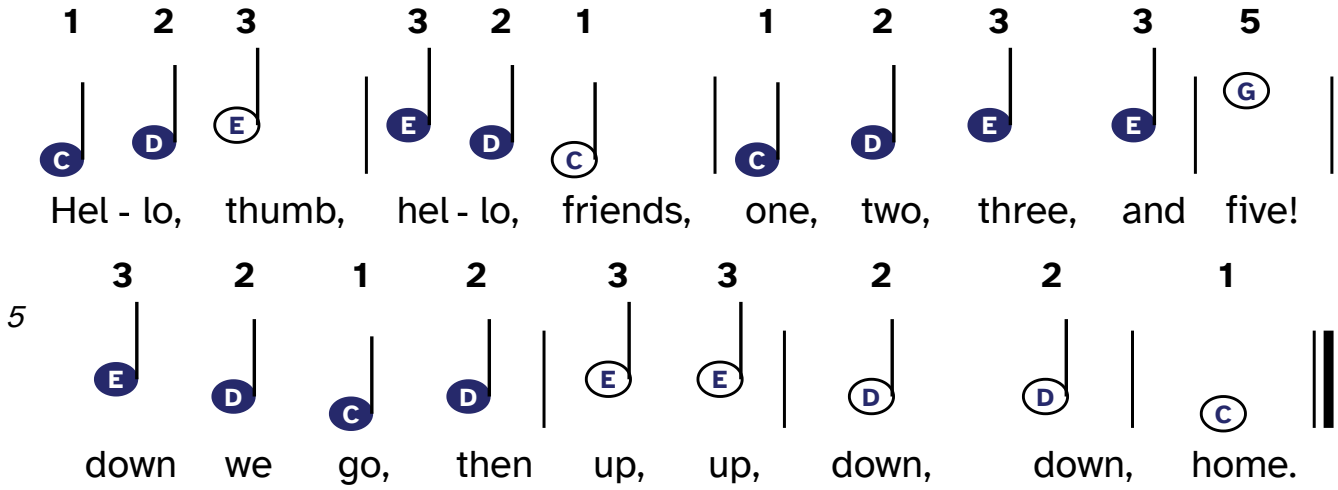
TOY SOLDIERS

A march, crisp and steady: C, D and E, a skip from C to E, and one long BOOM to hold. Sing along!



HELLO, THUMB

A friendly wave, a peek at Lesson 3: the same keys with new fingers, thumb on C, then finger 5 reaches up to G.



- [ ] Played Toy Soldiers
- [ ] Played Hello, Thumb